

LIBERATION AND PEACE BY OVERCOMING FEAR OF THE UNKNOWN

Greetings, my dearest friends. Blessings this evening for each one of you. Blessed be your every effort in the direction of self-development, liberation, and self-realization. In spite of the recent interruption, I should like to continue with the last series of lectures.

One of the fundamental human predicaments is man's struggle to overcome the duality between life and death. From this basic predicament derive all other problems, difficulties, fears, and the tensions that man has to contend with. Whether this manifests as the direct fear of death in times one confronts it, or as the fear of aging, or the fear of the unknown in any form -- it is always fear of the passing of time. They are all manifestations of the same nucleus.

In order to assuage these fears, man has created philosophies -- philosophical, spiritual, religious concepts. But as long as he adopts concepts, even if they are the result of a true experience of one individual who attempts to pass it on, the real tension will not be relieved. The only way to truly overcome this hardship is by delving into the first unknown that man fears so much and which finally leads to overcoming the great duality, and that is his own psyche. This sounds simpler than it really is. To explore the unknown corners of one's own mind is by no means just a question of either/or. There are many who ardently pursue a path of self-exploration, yet they shy away from certain facets of their innermost selves. The resulting tension and disturbance is then glibly explained away by outer reasons. Yet they are "on the path." They may have even made considerable progress and even resolved certain facets of their inner conflicts, but vast areas of their psyche remain unknown.

To the degree that you are unaware of what goes on in you, fear of the passing of time, fear of the "great unknown" must exist. When one is young, these fears may be assuaged. One may not be aware that they exist except in times of jeopardy. But sooner or later, every human being must be confronted with the more direct fear of death. I emphasize again, to the degree that man knows himself, does he fulfill his life, himself, his dormant potentials. And to that degree, death cannot be feared, but experienced as an organic development. The unknown factor can no longer be a threat.

This path of self-discovery represents such a struggle, my friends. The areas of escape, even within the framework of this path, are too varied to enumerate. Only your unceasing will and ruthless truthfulness with yourself to see, to evaluate, to comprehend, to connect, and to unify will finally yield more and more results in this respect.

One of the great factors in overcoming the fear of death is to overcome the fear of letting go of the barriers which separate you from the opposite sex. As long as these barriers exist, fear of death must exist in equal proportion. There is a very direct connection, my friends, between the fear of one's own unconscious, the fear of love with the opposite sex, and fear of death. The connection

between the first two is beginning to dawn on you, the third part of the triad may still be a novel idea. However, it will cease to be an arresting theory once you experience the connection yourself in the effort of self-understanding. You will then know the truth of these words.

If you truly understand the contents of the last lecture, you will see that self-fulfillment depends on fulfilling yourself as a man or, respectively, as a woman. You cannot fulfill yourself, in the last sense, without overcoming the barrier between yourself and the opposite sex, thus truly becoming a man or a woman. Of course, there are also other aspects of self-fulfillment, or the lack of it. Man may be unaware of certain potentials he possesses; of his talents; of his strength; of all the good qualities he inherently has; of his courage and resourcefulness; of the wideness of his mind; of the creativeness of his spirit. But none of these aspects can truly unfold in their inherent splendor unless man truly becomes a man, woman truly becomes a woman. The self-realization that takes place while the barrier to union with a mate remains can only be a partial and conditional one. For, this barrier indicates a barrier to areas within the self that one shies away from exploring and understanding. It indicates a resistance to fully grown selfhood and an insistence on artificial infancy. This nurtured parasitical state prevents liberation and the overcoming of fear, which is a product of duality.

When all resistance to unknown areas in oneself has vanished and therefore one no longer fears oneself, one cannot possibly fear other human beings, the other sex. A great inner freedom and trust, born out of objective realism, removes the tight grip that stands in the way of letting oneself go into the state of being. When man fulfills himself, there no longer is a barrier; there is no longer a holding on in fear of the unknown, in distrust of the self and of the other. It is this same holding on that prevents man from entering into the cosmic stream of timelessness which he experiences in the highest bliss of union with a mate and which he experiences in the highest bliss in what man calls death.

Death has many facets. For him who is afraid, holding tightly to the little self, death may be experienced as fearful seclusion and separateness. But for him who is not afraid of living fully, to reach out and no longer preserve the little self, death is the glory that union on this earth can be and more so! Therefore the struggle of self-realization, in the last analysis, must mean the following! First is the removal of the barriers between your consciousness and the hidden areas of your psyche. These hidden areas are not always covered up, unconscious -- they are often right in front of your eyes if you but choose to look at them. They are not so far from sight. They only appear to be. Second is the removal of the barriers between you and your counterpart, whoever he or she may be at a given phase. And the next barrier is between you and the cosmic stream. Wherever this stream carries you, you will see that it is right. It is functional at this stage of your being. It is organic. But man, in his fear of himself and of the other and therefore of the stream of being, does not trust the passing of time. He holds on with his little self and wants to determine with his little self. Thus he creates a wall of clouds between his higher consciousness and his momentary awareness.

A long time ago, I discussed that three basic, major hindrances are pride, self-will, and fear. I tried to show you how all faults and later how all problems, confusions, distortions, conflicts, and misconceptions derive from pride, self-will, and fear, at least in one form or another. It is this same triad which constitutes the barrier to the three facets of self-expansion just discussed. Let us consider this more closely.

First is the barrier between consciousness and what exists in the unconscious mind, pride. It bars the way because you may not like what you find. It may not be flattering and not compatible with the idealized self-image. Even if the result of the finding proves not to be derogatory, you fear that it might be so. The importance of being looked upon with admiration makes you adopt standards and values of others whose approval you seek. This creates a block of pride, a wall, a cloud, which hinders insight.

Self-will bars the way in your apprehension that what you find may force you to do something that your little self is not inclined to do, to give up, or to assume a way of life that seems unwelcome, often merely because it is new and unfamiliar. Self-will wants the little ego to be in control, and it must therefore cling to the known. Fear bars the way in that both pride and self-will indicate a lack of trust, believing rather that the final reality is not to be trusted. Cosmic reality, imbedded in your deep unconscious and existing in the stream of cosmic events if you enter into it, cannot help but be benign, bringing happiness and fulfillment and meaningfulness. Distrusting this fact and therefore holding on to what you know in the belief that you might fare better than by taking the chance of entering the unknown, creates walls of fear. It is this fear that blocks full self-recognition.

The triad of pride, self-will, and fear applied to the barrier between the self and losing the self in love to a mate are manifest. Pride applies because, whether man or woman, you fear the apparent helplessness, and therefore shame, of being given up to a force of experience greater than your little self. Love between the sexes is a humbling experience and therefore the enemy of pride. Your pride wants to direct and control. It does not want to be given up to any force even if this force is most desirable. And even though you and everyone else go through life desiring this experience while at the same time blocking it and finding ways and means toward a compromise between both contradictory drives or directions of your soul. The force driving you into this experience is great indeed, for it derives from your innermost nature. The second drive deriving from pride, self-will, and fear pushes you into the opposite direction. Self-will is again opposed to the experience because it wants all control. It cannot give itself up. It erroneously seems to you that only by obeying and being governed by the little self are you safe. You are under the misapprehension that giving yourself up to this force is one and the same as heedless and headless greed, unreasonableness, and unrealism. This is not so, as I have pointed out time and again. Realism, objectivity, the ability to relinquish, and fearless willingness to enter the great experience are not only compatible but interdependent. You block the experience in the fear of losing your dignity -- therefore pride -- and your selfhood -- therefore self-will -- when, in reality, true dignity and selfhood can only be gained by giving up pride and self-will.

The fear of losing safety and of one's very life is not so different from the fear that blocks the blissful experience of self-forgetfulness in union with a mate. Some of you may sense the similarity, at least occasionally.

The triad of pride, self-will, and fear applies to one's attitude to death in a way very similar to one's attitude to the love experience with a mate, only much more so. Dying means giving up the final self-direction; and this, strange as this may seem, in a certain way appears humiliating. In order to avoid the humbling truth that the little self is not all-powerful, man holds on to it in pride and self-will, thereby creating ever stronger waves of fear.

In order to overcome this erroneous duality, particularly the conflict between giving up the self and full possession of the self, I would like to say what may indeed sound like a paradox. You find yourself in the labor of such a path of self-realization in order to be capable of giving yourself up -- in union with the other sex, and in death. You cannot give up successfully that which you have not found. For you cannot freely let go of something you have never really possessed. Only when you can give it up freely, will you gain more -- selfhood!

Now, the question may arise, if death, or dying, or the state of dying, or of being dead can be such a blissful experience, why then is the perception of this so darkened? Why does not the instinct toward it exist as, for example, the strong instinct toward losing oneself in love? Why must it be blocked off without the help of instinctual drives, therefore necessitating such hard work to overcome the barrier? You may ask, "Why is it that we on this earth have to battle against this great unknown?" Upon first glance, such questions seem justified and logical, but when you take a closer look, you will understand that it must be as it is. You see, my friends, the confusion would be so easy to wish death because you cannot cope with life, because life is painful and unfulfilled. In this unfinished, ignorant, and blind state of being in terror of life and not desirous of coping with the issues of life, you would all too easily escape into death even though in this case death would not provide a different experience than life -- for both are intrinsically the same. In order to avoid such a destructive escape, the life instinct must be so strong and can operate only as long as death remains an unknown factor. No words will remove this fear of the unknown so that your life instinct will prevent you from choosing death out of a negative, destructive motivation because you cannot cope with what you have now. This strengthens the stamina to try and try again until finally life is mastered through self-realization, through removal of fears as a result of understanding the self and hence the universe. In this endeavor, the inner understanding finally dawns that death is not to be feared -- or, it is feared only in exact proportion as aspects of living and loving are feared. Hence, the sharp differentiation between life and death, its illusory duality, begins to dwindle. The true understanding of these words can come only when life is no longer a threat and no longer needs to be fled so that your life instinct will then no longer have to be an opposing factor to the death instinct. It will then be one and the same. You will then not need to rush ahead, nor will you need to hold back.

If you look at your soul movements regarding the passing of time, and your conscious or unconscious attitude toward life and death, you will find that they are identical and that both are identical with your innermost and hidden attitudes toward love, regardless of conscious, healthy desires in this respect. You will find that the fear of the unknown plays a role in all of them. You will find that you constantly fluctuate between holding back time in fear, in a cramped motion, and rushing ahead because you cannot stand the moment. Very rarely indeed are you in harmony with the cosmic stream of your particular life manifestation, your individuality. This is what being in peace with oneself, being in harmony with God, really means: not holding back, not pushing toward, but dissolving in the life stream, in full possession of yourself, yet without fear of giving up self-possession. This is the great experience that man is blessed and privileged to have -- when finding his mate. And this will ultimately be the experience when going into a new form of consciousness.

The key to all of this must lie, can only lie, in self-discovery in the many levels and areas in which you still shy away from looking at yourself. When you avoid parts of yourself, you cannot help but project outwardly onto others and into the outside life what seems like a terrifying

self-confrontation. Hence the projection cannot yield peace and liberation regardless of how much precarious temporary satisfaction it appears to give. You always find "reasons" and excuses outside of yourself in order to hedge what so needs to be tackled. This applies to practically all of my friends at least occasionally. But all of you also make progress, and each little step in the right direction must finally dissolve the clouds, the barriers between you and this higher consciousness that is that timeless stream. It furnishes you with all the wisdom, truth, rightness you need for your everyday life. Some of you have occasionally tapped this source, have experienced it only to lose it again. When you have contact with this inner source of peace and truth, with the highest bliss of the state of being and yet of lively, active experience, and with the rightness of all answers you precisely (not vaguely) seek, then you will deeply comprehend the significance of the creation as you see the sun, around which all other planets revolve, while it remains constant in its bright light even though it is often covered by clouds. The clouds are your pride, your self-will, and fear, your ignorance, and your stemming against the wave of time, or your hurrying ahead of it. But in the moments you perceive your truth -- be it ever so banal, mundane, apparently insignificant in terms of cosmic development -- the clouds disperse, and the warm sun of your higher consciousness regenerates you with strength and well-being, with joyfulness and peace. This sun within yourself is ready to constantly warm and enliven you, but you, my dearest ones, must overcome much more -- much more! Then will all fears, all pride, and all self-will fall from you. To say that it already has, will not make it so. If it had done it, many of your reactions, your feelings, your expressions, the effect you have on others, and effects others have on you could be drastically different.

This is not an easy topic to understand. It needs more than searching understanding with your mind. This in itself will accomplish little. It needs the deeper understanding of your being, which can come only when you look at the feelings that keep you from happiness at this moment, in the now. If you look at your desires and fears, your needs, your apprehensions, and reactions -- right or wrong -- at this moment, at each moment, then you find into the eternal now. In it, you can live fearlessly with the rightful confidence in the unknown. You do not have to become perfect. You are perfect, in a sense, when you can calmly face, acknowledge, and in full understanding come to terms with your present imperfection.

By no longer struggling against the self, thus shedding pride and pretense, yet being willing to change, thus shedding self-will, the fear of self, of others, of life, of love, and of dying -- all these evaporate like ice in the sun.

Are there any questions now regarding this topic, on the spur of the moment?

QUESTION: What about a person who does not fear death for himself, but just for people he loves. In other words, if the fear of death exists for other people?

ANSWER: This may easily be a projection. It may also be a reversal from the fear of life. If one fears life, certain other people may represent the security one feels lacking in oneself. One may fear loneliness, lack of actual or irrational protection by the loss of others. Just because these facets may not be faced in a sense of shame that one may not really mourn so much in love but rather in self-concern, the fear becomes increasingly gnawing, persistent, and disturbing. By having the courage to look at all these possible emotions after having overcome the initial reluctance, the fear of the death of others will diminish. The bitter, frightening aspect of it will disappear, and one can

then look at the causes of one's own helplessness. Attaching the fear or other negative emotions to where it really belongs rather than experiencing it in displacement is always a relief.

But only then does the work begin in finding why one fears life so much that one has to cling to others and why one does not use the inborn faculties so as to live fully and therefore to no longer fear life or death. If you fear life, you must also fear death, whether you consciously experience the latter in incidents when your life is, or seems, endangered or whether you do so in fearing the loss of others. Fear of coping with life can manifest as fear of loss of loved ones. And so does fear of losing one's life. If this is still remote, is not a factual reality, the approaching death of others triggers the reminder that this will come to the self too one day. But this fear is still so hazy that one experiences it only through the other person. Only when an actual confrontation occurs, can one really gauge whether or not one is afraid of dying.

This projection applies both to the fear of living alone and the fear of one's own death. And both these facets indicate the very same thing, as you can now judge from the contents of this lecture.

All this would have to be investigated. Wherever there exists a fear of life, of confronting a certain problem, you will be disturbed by the fear of death in one form or another. Often the real root -- in what respect fear of self and of life exists -- cannot be recognized at once. It may manifest by symptoms only, and one has to look for these symptoms and investigate them for their significance. For example, one's attitude to this pathwork, professed and factual; one's attitude to the opposite sex, again professed and actual; one's reactions to current life circumstances -- all this has to be looked at with a penetrating spirit of truthfulness. When you can determine a fear of, or to use a more psychological term, resistance to your innermost self, you can be sure fear of death must exist in equal measure -- and also a fear of loving, of letting go of yourself in this great experience. Find it, see it in yourself, and you will have conquered a great deal.

Of course, these words are directed to everyone.

It is also important to note that man is often misled in this respect because in his fantasy life these fears do not exist. When speaking about the fear of loving, of self-surrender, he may deny the existence of these fears because he is acutely aware of the fact that he ardently desires this fulfillment and experiences it without inhibition in fantasy. He then believes there are outer reasons responsible that he does not actually realize this fantasy life, reasons which have nothing to do with him. But if he cannot realize this fantasy life, there must be the opposite current in him which prevents the experience due to fear. To find it, to lift it out of hiding is so very important. It is a vast step forward, compared to the belief that one is free from obstructions, while they continue to exist underground.

Through this lecture, I have given various avenues by which one can explore the actual state of one's soul regarding life, love, and death. I showed that the conscious conviction and feeling may only be one side, while the other side has to be that of becoming aware in order to unify with the opposing force. I showed the various symptoms by which this hidden, opposite current can be determined. This is of the very greatest importance, and it may often lead out of a present bottleneck in this work.

QUESTION: Wouldn't a fear of being left also account for the fear of losing dear ones?

ANSWER: Yes, this is what I said at first -- the insecurity, the fear of having to confront life alone, hence the fear of life in pure form, once it is broken down and analyzed.

Where there is fear of life, there must be fear of love and of death. Where there is one of these fears, the other two must exist as well. When you establish this link within yourself, you are bound to experience growth, liberation, strength, confidence. It cannot be otherwise.

We shall enter into this topic more extensively when we come to the discussion of it. The next time we shall discuss two lectures together. May you all participate as actively as possible with general, theoretical, as well as personal and practical questions and examples as the subjects apply to you individually. This will indeed be for your benefit.

Blessings for each one of you. Do not despair, my friends, when you sense the barriers that I discussed tonight. Awareness of their existence removes them more than when you ignore their existence. Please realize and understand this important truth. Make it your own by testing it, and you will rejoice. Be blessed in this new awareness, each one of you. Be in peace, be in yourself and therefore in God!

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